



USER GUIDE · PART 04

Estimating

Build estimates, manage your price book, and win the job

Estimating

Estimating is where you turn a measured job into a priced proposal you can hand a customer — and then into a scheduled job once they say yes. It bundles your saved prices (the Price Book), a few field tools, and the estimate builder that produces a professional PDF and an online "approve" link.

Estimates — the proposal builder

The **Estimates** page lists your proposals — each row shows name, client, total, status, and last-updated date. From here you can start a **New Estimate**, start one **From Template**, duplicate one (📄, copies it as a fresh draft), or delete one. Click a row to open the builder.

Building an estimate

You fill in two header blocks — **Your Company** (auto-filled from your Company Profile, logo included; edits here apply to this one estimate only) and **Client** (name, email, address, project, estimate number, date, and a "valid until" date).

Line items — four ways to add them

Add from price book

Pick a saved item or a bundled assembly; it comes in already priced.

Blank / manual line

A row you fill in yourself.

From Takeoff

Pull measured quantities straight out of a Takeoff project — tick the items you want, add a **waste %** or a **± quantity adjustment**, and they drop in as lines. Prices start at zero, so set them after importing.

Every line has a Code (CSI division), name, description, quantity, unit, and a price. Each line can be priced two ways with the **Flat / Build-up** toggle:

Flat

You type a unit price; line total = qty × unit price.

Build-up

You enter material \$ plus labor (hours × rate) and the unit price is calculated for you.

Lines also support a private **internal note** (never shown to the customer) and an **Optional add-on** checkbox that lists the item separately instead of folding it into the total.

Markup, discount, tax, totals

Overhead % and Profit %

Your two markup layers, applied to the subtotal.

Category markup

An automatic per-trade markup when a line's Code matches a rule from your Company page.

Discount

A percent off or a flat dollar amount (toggle %/\$).

Tax (materials)

By default tax applies only to the material portion of build-up lines; flat prices are treated as tax-included.

Your markup stays private

Overhead, profit, and tax are internal — the customer's proposal never shows them as separate lines. They're folded into the prices you choose to display, and the Total stays correct.

What the customer sees

By default the proposal shows only item descriptions — no per-line numbers. You opt in to any of four columns: show quantity, show unit, show per-unit price, show line total. You can also offer **Good / Better / Best** — up to three named price tiers the customer chooses from; when they approve online, you're told which one they picked.

Scope, terms, and AI help

A Scope/Notes box prints as the "Scope of work." A Terms section sets "good for X days," a deposit %, and when the balance is due. If AI is enabled, two buttons appear: ✨ **Write scope** (turns rough notes into polished prose) and 🔍 **Check for gaps** (flags line items you may have forgotten).

Sending a proposal

✉ Email for approval

Emails the customer their proposal with an online "Review & approve" button. If your email isn't connected yet, it opens your own mail app with the link instead.

Open in email app

Opens your email client with the proposal link pre-written.

Generate PDF / ↓ Download PDF

A clean printable proposal in a new tab, or a real downloaded PDF file.

Statuses and converting to a job

The status dropdown offers **Draft, Sent, Accepted, Rejected**. When a customer approves online, it flips to **Accepted** automatically. An estimate past its "valid until" date is flagged **Expired**.

The **Convert to Job** button turns an accepted estimate into a scheduled job: the line items become the job's scope checklist and task list, and the budget/contract are frozen from the estimate's prices. After converting, the estimate **locks** — if you must change it, use  **Edit Estimate** and then **↑ Push changes to job** to keep them in sync. You can also **Save as Template** and use **Versions** to snapshot and roll back.

Price Book

Your saved list of work items and what they cost — these prices feed every estimate. Each item stores a **name, CSI code, unit, material \$ per unit, labor hours, labor rate, and waste %**, and Fieldscale computes the **Cost / unit** for you.

Code systems

Switch between Residential (2-digit CSI), Commercial (6-digit), or your own Custom codes.

Import / export

Import a CSV (with a column-mapping screen), export to CSV, load sample items to learn from, or clear all.

Assemblies

Bundle several items into one line (e.g. "Insulated 2×4 wall" = batt + vapor barrier + labor). Add the assembly once on an estimate, enter a quantity, and it prices all the parts.

The field tools

Field Measure

A quick on-site calculator when there's no drawing: enter dimensions and get Area (SF), Volume (CY), Linear (LF), Perimeter (LF), or Count (EA). Build a labeled list and **Copy list** into an estimate.

Cut List

A cut-list optimizer for linear stock (studs, plates, trim, decking). Enter the pieces you need and the stock lengths you can buy, plus a saw kerf, and it works out **how many boards to buy with the least waste**, with a visual cut plan and waste totals.

Floor Plans

A simple to-scale sketching tool for jobs with no drawings — draw walls (they snap to a grid), drop in doors/windows/fixtures, label rooms, set a scale, then save, print, or attach to an estimate.

The typical workflow

- 1 **Measure the job** — a Takeoff from plans, or Field Measure on site. Run the Cut List for linear stock; sketch a Floor Plan for a no-drawings remodel.
- 2 **Set up your Price Book** — your materials, labor rates, and waste (or import a CSV), plus assemblies for combos you use often. Do this once; reuse it forever.
- 3 **Create the estimate** — fill in the client and project (your company auto-fills).
- 4 **Add line items** — from the Price Book, imported From Takeoff, or manual. Price each line (flat or build-up).
- 5 **Price the job** — set overhead, profit, discount, and tax. Optionally add Good/Better/Best tiers and add-ons.
- 6 **Write scope & terms** — notes, deposit, balance-due, validity; use AI to polish if available.
- 7 **Send it** — choose the customer's columns, then Email for approval or Generate/Download the PDF. Mark it Sent.
- 8 **Win it** — the customer approves online (auto-Accepted), or you mark it Accepted.
- 9 **Convert to Job** — the line items become the job's scope and the budget locks in.

Tips & gotchas

- **Your Price Book drives everything.** Estimates are only as accurate as your saved material costs, labor hours, and rates — set these to your real numbers before quoting.
- **Takeoff imports start at \$0.** After pulling items From Takeoff, remember to set the prices.
- **Customer columns are off by default.** Tick them if you want the customer to see quantities or per-line pricing; otherwise they see descriptions only.
- **Optional add-ons aren't in the Total** — they're listed separately for the customer to choose.
- **Watch the "Valid until" date.** Once it passes, the estimate is flagged Expired — update the date or re-price before sending.
- **Converting to a Job locks the estimate.** The job becomes the source of truth; use Edit Estimate → Push changes to job to keep them in sync.
- **Field Measure and Cut List don't save to a job** — they're scratch calculators; use Copy list to move the results.